



Name: _____ Cohort/Batch: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____

CLOUDFORMATION PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 conceptual Q&A Cloud

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What is CloudFormation and what is its primary purpose in its cloud ecosystem?

Threat Model

Q6 How do you manage configuration and secrets for CloudFormation?

Observability

Q2 How does IAM work with CloudFormation?

Architecture

Q7 What are the main cost drivers for CloudFormation and how do you optimize them?

Lifecycle

Q3 How do you monitor CloudFormation in production?

Configuration

Q8 How do you implement high availability with CloudFormation?

Compliance

Q4 How do you scale CloudFormation to handle variable load?

Hardening

Q9 How does CloudFormation integrate with a CI/CD pipeline?

Testing

Q5 How do you secure CloudFormation in production?

SSO / IdP

Q10 What are common pitfalls when first adopting CloudFormation?

Tuning



ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 CloudFormation is a managed cloud service

Mitigation

CloudFormation is a managed cloud service that handles a specific infrastructure concern (compute, storage, messaging, AI). Using it shifts operational burden to the cloud provider while you focus on application logic.

A6 Store sensitive values in a managed

Observability

Store sensitive values in a managed secret store (AWS Secrets Manager, GCP Secret Manager, Azure Key Vault). Inject secrets as environment variables at runtime, never bake them into container images or source code.

A2 Access to CloudFormation is controlled via

Primitives

Access to CloudFormation is controlled via IAM roles and policies. Attach the minimum required permissions to a service account or role. Avoid long-lived access keys; use instance roles or Workload Identity Federation instead.

A7 Cost in CloudFormation typically comes from

Automation

Cost in CloudFormation typically comes from compute hours, data transfer, storage, and request counts. Right-size instances, use reserved capacity for steady-state workloads, and enable lifecycle policies to expire old data.

A3 CloudFormation emits metrics to the cloud

Hardening

CloudFormation emits metrics to the cloud provider's monitoring service (CloudWatch, Cloud Monitoring, Azure Monitor). Set alerts on key metrics (error rate, latency, capacity). Use distributed tracing to correlate across services.

A8 Deploy CloudFormation across multiple

Governance

Deploy CloudFormation across multiple availability zones. Use managed replicas or active-active configurations. Implement health checks and automatic failover. Test resilience regularly with chaos engineering or failover drills.

A4 CloudFormation supports auto-scaling policies

Gotchas

CloudFormation supports auto-scaling policies based on CPU, queue depth, or custom metrics. Set minimum and maximum capacity. Horizontal scaling (more instances) is generally preferred over vertical for cloud workloads.

A9 CI/CD pipelines use the cloud CLI

Assessment

CI/CD pipelines use the cloud CLI or SDK to deploy updates to CloudFormation after tests pass. Infrastructure-as-code (Terraform, CDK) defines CloudFormation configuration as version-controlled code deployed via the pipeline.

A5 Place CloudFormation in a private subnet

Federation

Place CloudFormation in a private subnet with no public endpoint where possible. Use VPC security groups or firewall rules to allow only required traffic. Encrypt data at rest and in transit. Rotate credentials regularly.

A10 Common mistakes include misconfigured IAM

Optimization

Common mistakes include misconfigured IAM policies (too permissive), no cost alerting, deploying only in one availability zone, and missing backups. Read the service SLA carefully to understand what the cloud provider guarantees.